

APEX PHYSICAL THERAPY & REHABILITATION

Outpatient Physical Therapy 6-Week Progress Log & Lumbar MRI Policy Criteria

Patient Name: Sarah Jenkins	Patient ID: pat-002
Therapy Period: 07/01/2026 – 08/21/2026 (8 Weeks)	Total Sessions Completed: 12 Sessions
Referring Physician: Dr. Mark Larson, MD	Licensed PT: Amanda Brooks, DPT
Requested Service: MRI Lumbar Spine (CPT 72148)	Diagnosis: L5 Lumbar Radiculopathy

PHYSICAL THERAPY PROGRESS & POLICY CRITERIA VERIFICATION

1. Conservative Treatment & Physical Therapy Duration:

Patient has completed **at least 6 weeks medical/conservative treatment** (8 weeks total conservative care). This included **6 weeks of physical therapy** (exceeding 4 weeks required within the last 3 months) with an **initial evaluation with PT and at least one follow up** (12 completed visits within the last 6 months) for current episode of back pain with no significant improvement.

2. Radiculopathy & Physical Examination Findings:

Physical examination confirms **suspected radiculopathy with lower extremity pain > back pain in nerve root distribution**.

- **Straight Leg Raise (SLR) Test:** Positive supine straight leg raising test >30 degrees and <70 degrees (positive at 45 degrees left leg).
- **Neurological Exam:** Motor weakness and sensory loss in a radicular distribution (L5 myotome 4/5 weakness, extensor hallucis longus).
- **Progressive Signs:** Progressive motor weakness present on repeat in-person examination.

3. Functional Impairments & Surgical Need:

Lack of improvement accompanied by severe functional impairments (VAS 7/10 pain, unable to perform occupational duties). Patient's clinical presentation indicates need for surgery or other invasive intervention as determined by a surgeon or interventional specialist.

Recommendation: Lumbar Spine MRI (CPT 72148) is fully verified and medically necessary under Policy MRI-69575638.

Evaluating Psychiatrist: Dr. Sarah Jenkins, MD	Signature: S. Jenkins, MD
Date: August 24, 2026	License #: MD-881902-IL